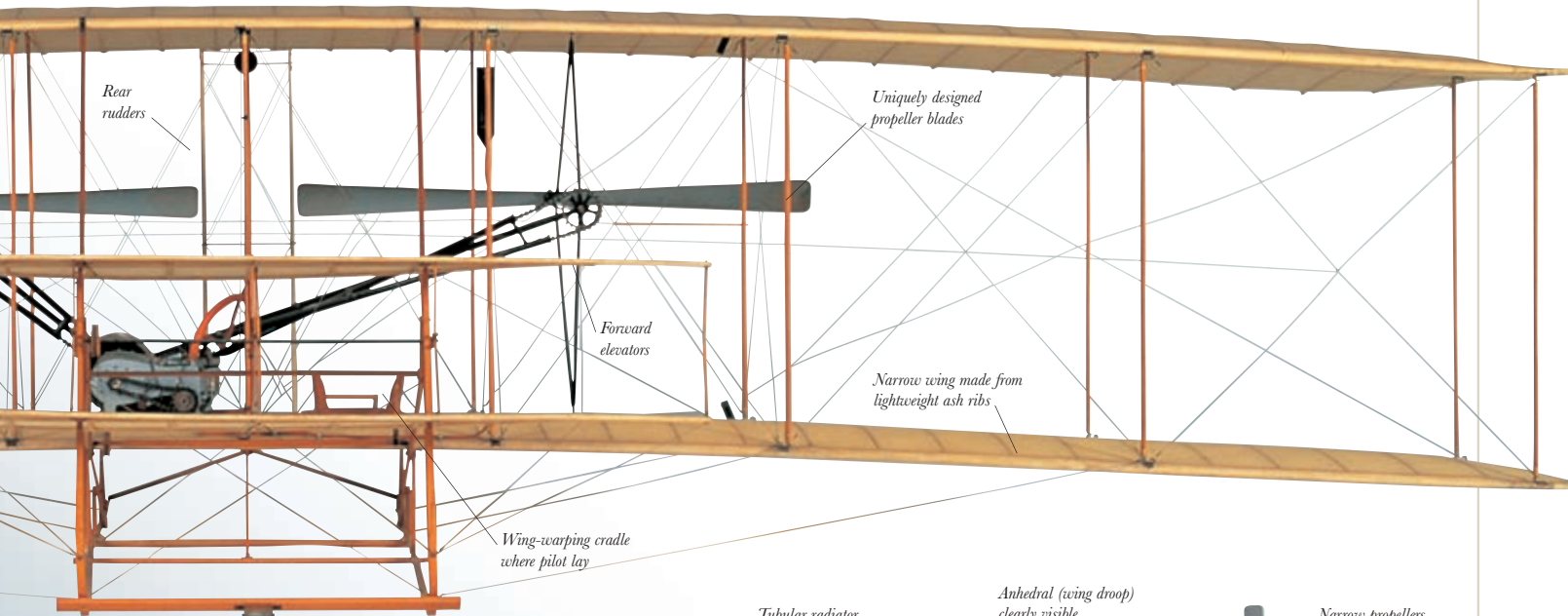
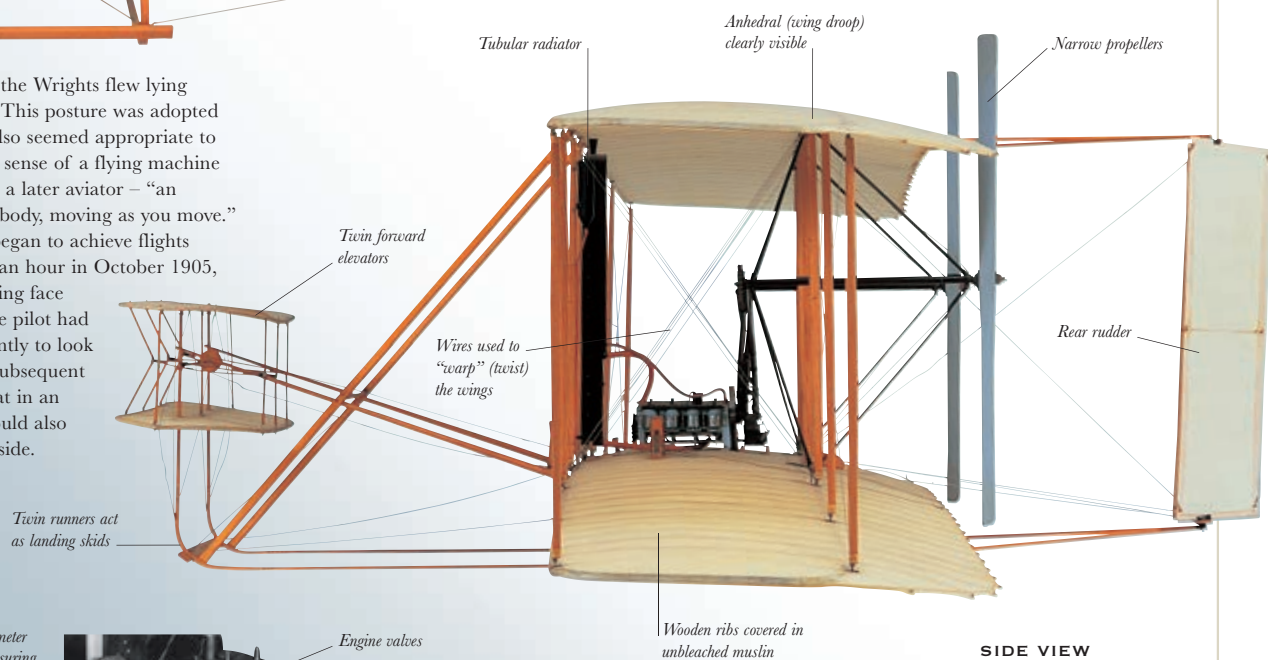




Until the end of 1905, the Wrights flew lying prone on the machine. This posture was adopted to reduce drag, but it also seemed appropriate to the Wrights' instinctive sense of a flying machine as – using the words of a later aviator – “an extension of your own body, moving as you move.”

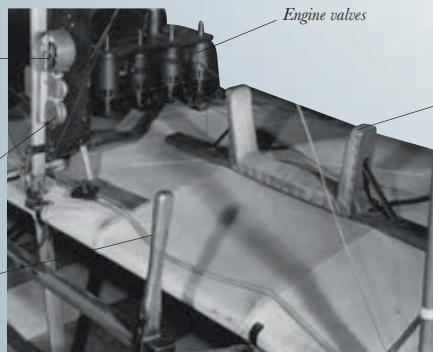
When the Wrights began to achieve flights lasting more than half an hour in October 1905, the impracticality of lying face down was realized – the pilot had to arch his neck constantly to look straight ahead. In the subsequent Type A, the operator sat in an upright position and could also have a passenger alongside.



Anemometer for measuring wind speed

Flight-data recording instruments

Elevator control lever



CENTER SECTION

This close-up of the central section of the lower wing shows where the pilot lay and from where he controlled the airplane. The engine and flight-data instruments were positioned to his right.

Specifications

ENGINE	12hp water-cooled four-cylinder gasoline engine
WINGSPAN	40ft 4in (12.3m)
LENGTH	21ft 1in (6.4m)
HEIGHT	13ft 5in (4.1m)
WEIGHT	750lb (338kg) with pilot; 605lb (274kg) empty
TOP SPEED	30mph (48.3kph)